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Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

Overbr^{ain}in!

The Internet is becoming more than an information repository. What will it eventually turn into?

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Information rules like never before. And the Internet is the enabler of today's information; it's like the nervous system of a world in the information age. It is seething with information of all types, in many languages, at many levels, serving the needs of diverse populations, driving business, dispensing entertainment, creating never-before-imagined communication channels.

There is a remarkable similarity—and one that cannot be taken lightly—between an individual brain and the Internet. The brain has a memory system that allows it to store and retrieve information; the Internet is a massive shared memory, with information being stored and retrieved all the time. Then, there is the network effect: in the brain, it is the *network* of neurons, with all their connections, that gives rise to its intelligence. The Internet, too, depends on the network effect for

